John Guthrie

Product Management and Business Systems

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Dual South African and British citizen | Open to international remote work and relocation

Professional profile

Product and business systems professional connecting customer needs with product priorities, technical feasibility and release readiness. Experience includes telematics product management at MiX, vehicle-tracking solutions at Astrata and enterprise and geospatial software consulting at Intergraph UK. Owns full-lifecycle delivery of commerce platforms, web applications and native iOS/Android apps, including cloud integration, automation and AI implementation.

Core capabilities

Full product lifecycle ownership | Product discovery and prioritisation | Requirements and acceptance criteria | Roadmap communication | Stakeholder alignment | Release management | API integration | Automation and AI implementation

Professional experience

Business Owner and Product Lead

Independent technology and commerce ventures, South Africa | 2008 to present

- Lead product direction and development of IntelliCommerce, centralising commerce operations across seven WooCommerce storefronts.
- Turn commercial and operational needs into product priorities, functional requirements and acceptance criteria for orders, fulfilment, supplier workflows and customer communications.
- Connect storefront data, supplier processes and customer records through systems integration and workflow automation.
- Lead delivery of serverless business applications on Cloudflare, integrating APIs, operational databases, document storage and asynchronous processing; manage Google Cloud projects and API integrations.
- Own the full product lifecycle across web and native iOS/Android apps: discovery, requirements, development, testing, app-store submissions and ongoing operation.
- Design AI-supported workflows and agent harnesses using reusable instructions, tool integrations, context management and verification checks.
- Founded and ran RAiN Digital Marketing (2018 to 2021), delivering websites, SEO and content services for South African SMEs.

Product Manager

CI-OmniBridge, subsequently MiX Telematics, South Africa | June 2006 to August 2008

- Connected customer requirements with engineering feasibility, product roadmap planning and release readiness for fleet-management hardware and software.
- Investigated product capability questions with engineering, identified validation needs and proposed field trials.
- Reviewed technical specifications and product-review documents for approval, including field-trial requirements and release responsibilities.
- Helped define reporting-performance requirements and review functional specifications with engineering and Microsoft Services; aligned customer-facing teams on roadmap timing and delivery assumptions.

Earlier enterprise experience

Systems Analyst and Senior Product Consultant

Astrata South Africa, vehicle tracking and location-based systems | April 2004 to May 2006

- Created system design specifications and UML use cases; supported interface design, acceptance tests, integrated testing and field trials.
- Delivered international customer demonstrations and pilot implementations, including deployment work in Singapore.
- Developed modular training and technical-support programmes for regional offices, dealers and partners; supported Siemens partnerships in Dubai and Pakistan.

Application Engineer Pre Sales

Intergraph UK, Mapping and Geospatial Solutions | July 2003 to March 2004

- Delivered G/Technology demonstrations, requirements specifications and RFI/RFP responses for utilities and communications customers.
- Developed Oracle data models and training materials; worked with SQL and PL/SQL, administration, migration, backup and performance tuning.

Application Engineer Post Sales

Intergraph UK, Process Power and Offshore | April 2002 to June 2003

- Supported SmartPlant Foundation customers and developers, tested releases and customisations, and assisted with implementation and customer environments.

Technical Pre Sales Consultant

Orbital Software, UK, knowledge and document management | February 2001 to December 2001

- Ran discovery workshops, prepared functional specifications and proposals, and demonstrated knowledge and document-management solutions to enterprise prospects.
- Developed a deployment process adopted by channel partners and provided customer and partner training.

IT Manager Support and Deployment

Master Maths, South Africa | 1998 to 2001

- Managed software and infrastructure deployment, training and ongoing support across more than 65 networked educational institutions in Africa.

Education and professional qualifications

Oracle Certified Professional DBA, Oracle 8i and 9i | Earned 2002, USA, following intensive classroom training.

Business Management Diploma, Helderberg College | 1997

Management Information Systems Certificate, INTEC College, 2000 | Delphi Programming Diploma with distinction, Helderberg College, 2000 | CompTIA A+, 1999

Selected platforms and technology

Cloudflare application platform: Workers, D1 SQL, R2 object storage, KV, Queues, Durable Objects, scheduled jobs and Wrangler; DNS, CDN and caching.

Google Cloud: Projects, IAM/service accounts, OAuth2, API integration, billing and gcloud; Gemini API and Firebase App Distribution.

Automation and integration: n8n, Pabbly Connect, Zapier, Google Apps Script, REST APIs, webhooks, Google Workspace and WhatsApp Business.

AI and development tools: OpenAI ChatGPT/Codex, Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini/Antigravity, Grok (xAI/SpaceXSI), Visual Studio Code and Git/GitHub; agent harnesses and reusable skills.

Web and native mobile delivery: React, TypeScript/JavaScript, Node.js, Hono, Vite; React Native/Expo, web apps/PWAs, App Store Connect, Google Play Console and Expo EAS.

Commerce and payments: WooCommerce, WordPress, Linux/Plesk, earlier Magento Open Source; payment gateway integration, subscription billing, Lemon Squeezy and in-app purchases.